

What Kind of Thought Is This?

Sometimes our minds use familiar patterns that make things feel more extreme. Let's identify the pattern and respond more flexibly.

1. My thought

Mark where this happened.

At home


☐

With friends


☐

At school


☐

Online


☐

In my body


☐

Other


☐


The thought that came up for me: _____

2. What kind of pattern is here?

You can mark more than one.



All-or-nothing

Mind reading

Negative filter

Overgeneralizing

Fortune telling

Exaggerating

3. What does it look like in an example?

This reminds me of:

If I made one mistake –
I'm terrible

If they didn't answer me –
they're upset with me

4. How does this pattern affect me?



It makes me feel worse ☐

I get scared ☐

I get tense ☐

I shut down ☐

I lose confidence ☐

I move away ☐

How much does it affect me?



5. A more flexible thought



There is more
than one
possibility

Maybe I don't
know
everything

One mistake
does not
define me

It's possible
to check

There are good
things too

My flexible thought:

Thought Reminder

A thinking pattern is a habit of the mind – not a fact.

When I recognize the pattern,
I can speak to myself in a more balanced way.

